1 River Water and Lake Water

River is a channel through which fresh water flows. The origin of river is usually hills or mountains. It flows towards lakes, sea and ocean. Lake is an area filled with water. Man-made lakes created when dam is built on a river is called reservoir. Small areas filled with water are called ponds. Rivers, streams, groundwater, rainfall, melting snows or a combination of these are the sources of water in lakes, reservoirs and ponds. As less amount of salt is dissolved in it, it is suitable for drinking and irrigation.



2 Sea Water

Sea water has salinity of approximately 3.5% or 35 parts per thousand. This means that every 1000 ml of sea water contains 35 grams of salts (Sodium chloride) dissolved in it. Due to the presence of more amount of salt, sea water is called saline water. It is not suitable for irrigation as well as drinking.



3 Underground Water

During rainfall, part of the rain water gets absorbed in the soil. It flows through various layers of the soil till it reaches hard rock, where it gets accumulated to form reservoir. This reservoir of water is the underground water. This water may contain soluble salts of calcium and magnesium. Underground water is made available for human use either as well water or as spring water.



Do you know?

Underground water is free from suspended impurities, because it is filtered by nature as it passes through several layers of the soil.

4 Well Water

When the earth's surface is dug deep, water reservoirs are found above the rocks. The depth of a well varies from place to place. Well water contains soluble impurities depending upon the nature of the soil.



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